



Rural India joined the party with helicopters now replacing horses at farm weddings to ferry the groom to the bride's village

- The Sahara Group launched the country's first customised luxury holiday package, Paradiso 101 Millionaire Holidays. For a substantial fee, clients would get access to high-end holidays at over 165 luxury properties across the globe, including exclusive islands at \$46,000 0 (Rs 18,13,080) a night.
- The acquisition of private aircraft in the country almost doubled in 2006-07, with 85 business jets added to the fleet compared to 45 the previous year.
- Thanks to relaxed rules on investing in property abroad, Indians have emerged as the key buyers of villas by Anahita in Mauritius, where property costs \$1.6-5.8 million (Rs 7-Rs 23 crore).
- Vodafone started selling unique mobile numbers priced at Rs 15 lakh onwards. All single digit numbers have been subscribed for as high as Rs 25 lakh, according to company spokesmen.
- The ownership of high-end LCD or plasma televisions has grown from 1.7 per cent to 3.5 per cent—an amazing 106 per cent increase. 'Lifestyle spend' was up by 20 per cent over 2007.



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- Retail management company KSA Technopak estimated the market for luxury and high-end clothing in India at Rs 1,000 crore and for accessories at another Rs 1,000 crore with the potential to grow at a faster clip than anywhere else in Asia except China.
- Upscale watchmaker Tag Heuer averaged 40 per cent growth in India over the last three years and is planing 40 more stores.
- There are 1.6 million households in India spending over Rs 4 lakh a year on jewellery, clothing, digital accessories, watches and cosmetics and skin care. These households will treble to three million in the next five years, says a study on luxury goods spending. The study presents a four-deck Indian Affluent pyramid: one million luxury households, six to seven million very affluent, nine to 10 million mid-affluent, and 14 to 15 million upper middle class. That translates into a potential market of \$16 billion (Rs 63,064 crore), with the number of very affluent households growing by 12-15 per cent.